

PitCrew — Getting Started Guide

Version 1.0 · July 2026

the-pitcrew.co

Welcome to PitCrew

PitCrew is a mentor-assist command center built for small and rebuilding FRC and FTC robotics teams. It brings together AI-powered planning tools, a student roster, and a season project workspace — all in one place.

This guide walks you through the complete signup process: from your first visit to a fully organized team with color-coded projects and invited students.

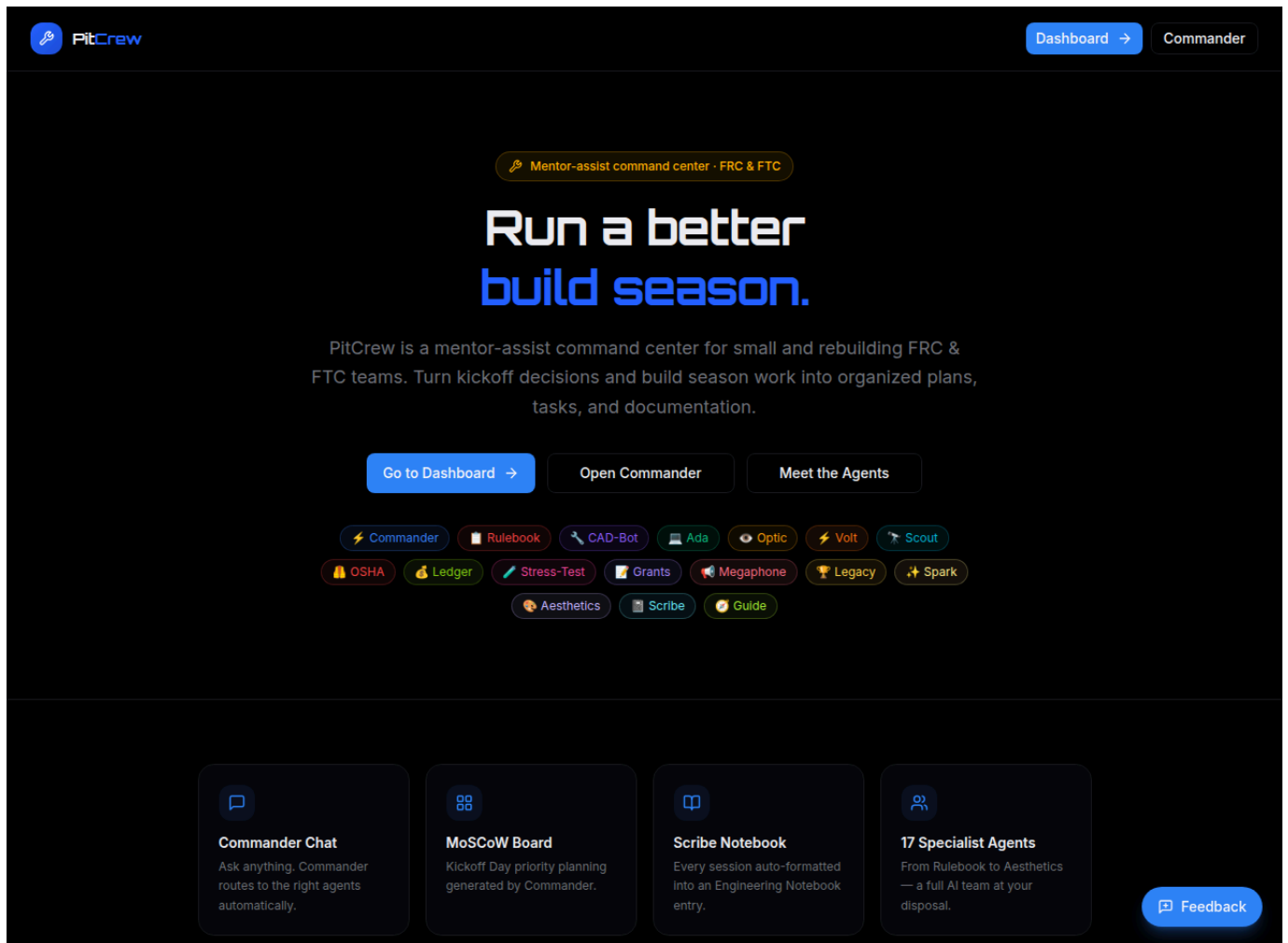
What You Will Need

- A Google account (for sign-in)
- Your team number and location
- Email addresses for any students you want to invite right away

That's it. No software to install. PitCrew runs entirely in the browser.

Step 1 — Visit the Site and Sign In

Open your browser and go to the-pitcrew.co.



You will see the PitCrew landing page with three options at the top:

Button	What It Does
Go to Dashboard	Takes you to your team workspace after sign-in
Open Commander	Opens the AI chat interface directly
Meet the Agents	Shows all 17 specialist AI agents available

Click **Go to Dashboard**. You will be redirected to the Manus login portal. Click **Continue with Google** and sign in with your Google account.

First-time login: If this is your first time signing in, PitCrew will automatically launch the team setup wizard after authentication. You do not need to navigate anywhere — it appears immediately.

Step 2 — Create Your Organization

The setup wizard opens with **Step 1: Create Your Organization**.

Fill in the following fields:

Field	Description
Organization Name	Your team's full name (e.g., "BioBuzz Robotics")
Team Number	Your FIRST-assigned team number (e.g., #12345)
Location	Your city and state
Program Type	Choose FRC , FTC , or Both

Choosing your program type:

- Select **FRC** if you run a FIRST Robotics Competition team only
- Select **FTC** if you run a FIRST Tech Challenge team only
- Select **Both** if you run both programs — students can be assigned to specific projects later, and crossover mentors are fully supported

Click **Next** when done. All of these details can be edited later from **Teams** → **Settings**.

Step 3 — Create Your First Project

The wizard moves to **Step 2: Create Your First Project**.

A *project* in PitCrew represents one season program — for example, "FRC 2027 Reefscape" or "FTC BioBuzz 2027". Each project has its own game link, task board, and student roster.

Fill in:

Field	Description
Project Name	A descriptive name (e.g., "FRC 2027 Reefscape")
Season Year	The competition year (e.g., 2027)
Program Type	FRC or FTC — this determines the color coding
Link a Game	Optional — search the Game Library to connect a game manual

Color coding:

- FRC projects display with a **blue** accent
- FTC projects display with a **green** accent

This color coding appears automatically on your dashboard project cards and throughout the app.

Click **Next**. You can add additional projects at any time from **Teams** → **New Project**.

Step 4 — Invite Your Students

The wizard moves to **Step 3: Invite Your Students**.

This step is optional during onboarding — you can skip it and invite students later from the **Teams** → **Invite** tab.

Adding Students to the Roster

Click **+ Add** and enter:

- **Name** — the student's first and last name
- **Email** — their school or personal email address

Repeat for each student. There is no limit to how many you can add.

Sending Invites

For each student in the roster, you have two options:

Option	How It Works
Send Email	PitCrew sends a branded invite email with a direct join link to the student's address
Copy Link	Copies a unique invite link you can share via Slack, Discord, text, or any other channel

You can also click **Send All Invites** at the bottom to email everyone on the roster at once.

Project-scoped invites: Each invite is tied to the specific project you selected. When a student accepts, they are automatically added to that project's member list — no manual

assignment needed.

Click **Done** (or **Skip**) to complete the wizard and land on your dashboard.

Step 5 — The Student Experience

When a student receives an invite email, here is what they see:

Email: A PitCrew-branded message showing your team name and the project they are being invited to join, with a **Join Now** button.

After clicking the link:

1. The student is taken to the PitCrew join page
2. They sign in with Google (one click)
3. They are shown a **role picker** with five options:

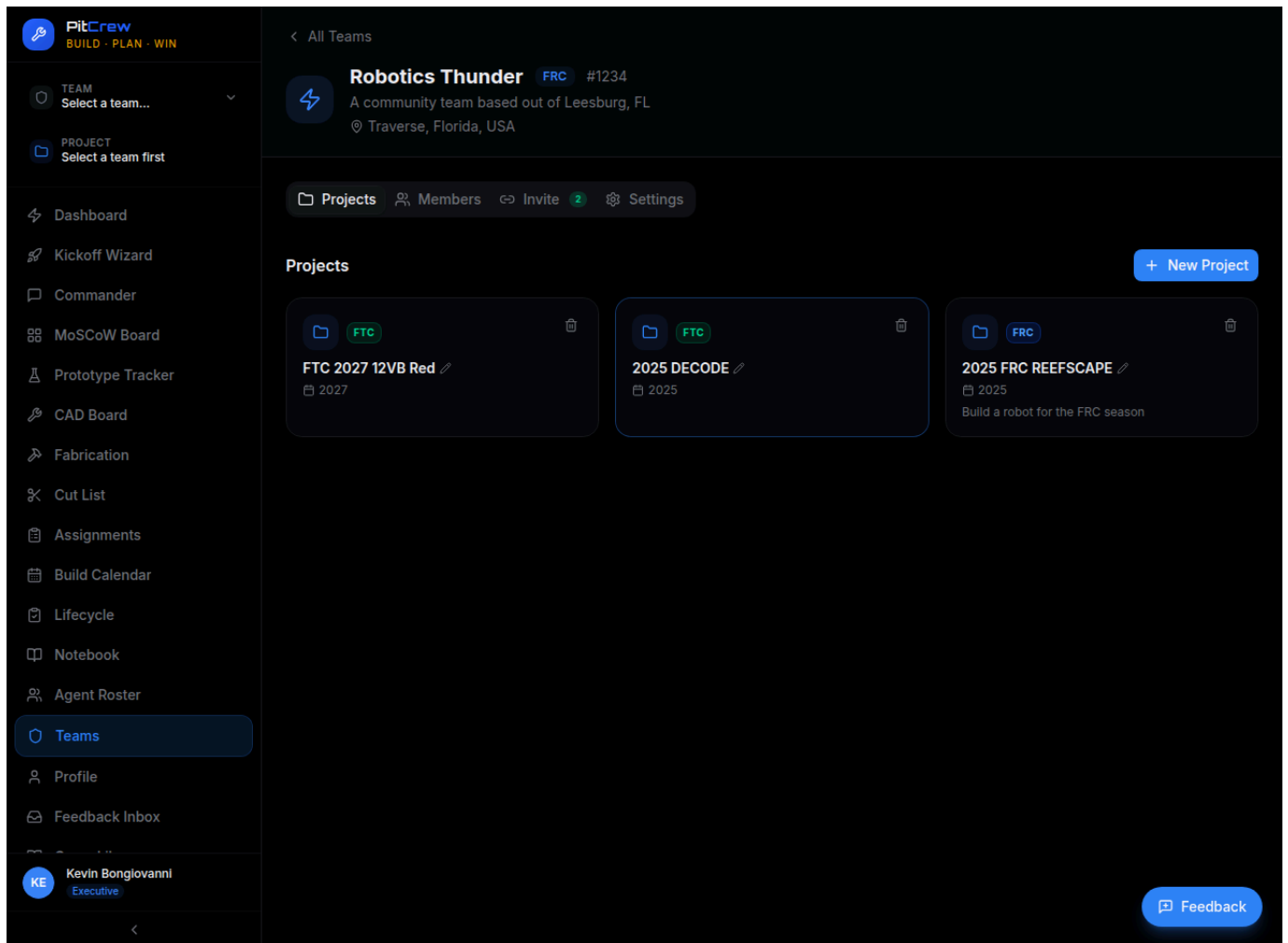
Role	Description
Executive / Strategy	Team leadership, strategy, and planning
Fabricator	Mechanical build, machining, and assembly
Integrator / CAD	Systems integration and CAD design
Operator / Programmer	Robot operation, controls, and software
Outreach	Community engagement and documentation

1. The student selects their role and clicks **Join Team**
2. They land on the dashboard, pre-assigned to the correct project

Why students pick their own role: This gives students ownership of their position on the team and saves mentors from manual assignment work. Roles can be updated at any time from the student's profile.

Step 6 — Your Dashboard After Onboarding

Once setup is complete, your **Teams** page shows your organization and all projects with color-coded badges.



Each project card shows:

- The project name and season year
- An **FRC** (blue) or **FTC** (green) program badge
- A colored left accent bar matching the program type

Click any project card to select it as your active project. The entire dashboard — Commander, MoSCoW Board, Kickoff Wizard, Notebook — updates to reflect the selected project's context.

What's Available Immediately After Setup

Once your team and first project are created, the following tools are ready to use:

Tool	What It Does
Commander	AI chat with 17 specialist agents — ask anything about your robot, game, or season
Kickoff Wizard	Guided game analysis and season planning session
MoSCoW Board	Priority planning board for kickoff day decisions
Scribe Notebook	Auto-formatted engineering journal — every Commander session becomes a notebook entry
Game Library	Upload game manuals, pre-season guides, and team updates — Commander uses them automatically

Adding More Students Later

You can invite additional students at any time:

1. Go to **Teams** in the left sidebar
2. Click your team name
3. Click the **Invite** tab
4. Select the project you are inviting them to (FRC, FTC, or Team-only)
5. Enter their name and email, then click **Send Invite** or **Copy Link**

Adding a Second Program (FRC + FTC)

If you started with FTC and want to add an FRC project (or vice versa):

1. Go to **Teams** → click your team
2. Click **+ New Project**
3. Fill in the project name, season year, and select the other program type
4. The new project card will appear with the corresponding color

Students can then be invited to the new project independently. Crossover students (e.g., an FRC mentor helping FTC) can be members of both projects simultaneously.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I change my organization name or team number after setup?

Yes. Go to **Teams** → **Settings** and edit any field.

Can a student change their role after joining?

Yes. Students can update their role from their **Profile** page at any time.

What if an invite email doesn't arrive?

Check the spam folder. If the issue persists, use the **Copy Link** option and share the link directly. The link is valid for 7 days.

Can I have multiple mentors with admin access?

Yes. Invite mentors the same way you invite students. Once they join, you can promote them to **Owner** from the **Members** tab.

Does PitCrew work on mobile?

Yes. The app is fully responsive and works on phones and tablets, though a desktop or laptop is recommended for the best experience during kickoff planning.

Support

For questions or feedback, use the **Feedback** button in the bottom-right corner of any page, or visit help.manus.im.
